

fixed with protected screws and nuts and reinforced material. In addition, the bike features GSM- and Bluetooth-based anti-theft tracking.

Moreover, the VanMoof team provides a paid recovery service; in case your bike gets stolen, the team guarantees your bike's retrieval or a full replacement. The service is called Peace of Mind. VanMoof bikes cost \$1100 onwards.

Mission Lyra

San Francisco-based bicycle manufacturer Mission has come up with a non-motorised smart bike that combines smart navigation and stunning design. Called Lyra, the bike integrates GPS system to provide constant directions to the rider.

A detachable battery keeps the system going. The battery has a microUSB port, which can be used to recharge the unit. What's more, an application developed by Mission for Android and iOS allows users to track their cycle from anywhere. It essentially does the work of a smart tag. So, if you do not find your cycle where you left it, or you forget where you parked it, simply use the application to tag its location.

Also, to ensure night-visibility, the bike has 100 LEDs strategically fixed into the fork and five LEDs running across the seatpost. The rider can toggle between the standard 65-degree

Mission Lyra bicycle
with LED-control
button highlighted



power saver bike light and a full 360-degree illumination—that too by pressing a single button!

Made of proprietary lightweight material, the bicycle is flexible yet sturdy. Mission Lyra starts at \$1100.

Other things to look out for

Additional gears are available to make bikes smart. For instance, a

small gadget called SmartHalo fits in the centre of a bike's two handlebars. Controllable through a mobile application, it instantly turns a normal bicycle into a smart bike with real-time navigation or route guidance, auto-controlled bike lights, anti-theft alarm and phone-based notification system, and fitness tracker. Finally, it notifies riders of calls and SMS as well. Interestingly, all these features come for just \$149!

How about non-electric bikes that can help us go green? French startup Pragma Industries has brought forward such a solution with the help of hydrogen gas. Called Alpha, their bikes use hydrogen fuel cells to run the miles. A two-litre tank of hydrogen allows these bikes to run 100km. The refill process is a matter of minutes, compared to hours taken by batteries of electric bikes to restart. Water is used to produce hydrogen, so it is a completely green setup utilising a renewable resource! As the Pragma bikes cost quite high for consumers, these are being offered to enterprises as of now. **EFY**

SmartHalo smart gear

